

Physical Geography

Physical Geography is the study of our home planet — its lands, waters, atmosphere, and interior. We work from Earth’s place in the universe down through the atmosphere, into the rocks of the crust, and out onto the surface, where tectonic forces, coastlines, rivers, wind, and ice are constantly rebuilding the landscape. By the end you should be able to look at a valley, a shoreline, or a storm and explain what produced it.

The class meets once a week for 26 weeks. Reading is done before class. Each week has an assigned unit and a quiz; four unit tests, a midterm, and a final are spread across the year.

The Text

Physical Geography (Version 1, 2020) by Professor Jeremy Patrich, College of the Canyons. Open Educational Resources, CC BY 4.0. 293 pages, 19 units.

Page numbers. Readings use the *printed* page numbers at the bottom of each page. Reading on screen, add 2 — printed page 76 is PDF page 78.

Grading

COMPONENT	WEIGHT	WHAT IT IS
Reading	20%	The week’s unit, plus a written paragraph on each <i>Think About It...</i> prompt. Due at the start of class.
Quizzes	30%	24 quizzes, 20 points each, one per week, on that week’s reading. The two lowest scores are dropped.
Unit Tests	20%	Four tests, 50 points each, in Weeks 5, 10, 19, and 23. Each covers three or four units.
Midterm	15%	100 points, Week 14. Units 1–11.
Final	15%	100 points, Week 26. Units 12–19 — the second half only.

A	B	C	D	F
90–100%	80–89%	70–79%	60–69%	below 60%

Policies

- **Late work** loses 10% per day, to a maximum of 50%. A missed quiz is recoverable — a missed test is not.
- **Retakes:** below 70% on a unit test, retake once within a week. The grade averages both attempts, capped at 80%. No retakes on the midterm or final.
- **All quizzes and exams are closed book.** Bring a notebook, colored pencils for diagrams, and an atlas or online map.

26-Week Schedule

Read the assigned pages before class. The quiz each week covers that reading.

First Half

WEEK	READ	PAGES	ASSESSMENT
1	Unit 1 — Introduction to Geography	7–21	Quiz 1
2	Unit 2 — Earth's Place within the Cosmos	22–38	Quiz 2
3	Unit 3 — Geology & Geologic Time	39–50	Quiz 3
4	Unit 4 — Mapping Earth's Surface	51–65	Quiz 4
5	Unit 5 — Earth–Sun Relationships	66–75	Quiz 5 TEST 1 • UNITS 1–4
6	Unit 6a — The Atmosphere: gases & layers	76–82	Quiz 6
7	Unit 6b — Atmospheric heat & circulation	83–94	Quiz 7
8	Unit 7a — Moisture, air masses & fronts	95–104	Quiz 8
9	Unit 7b — Extreme weather; weather vs. climate	105–114	Quiz 9
10	Unit 8 — Basic Mineral Development	115–124	Quiz 10 TEST 2 • UNITS 5–7
11	Unit 9 — Igneous Rocks	125–133	Quiz 11
12	Unit 10 — Sedimentary Rocks	134–150	Quiz 12
13	Unit 11 — Metamorphic Rocks	151–163	Quiz 13
14	REVIEW & MIDTERM EXAM	<i>review</i>	MIDTERM • Units 1–11

Second Half

WEEK	READ	PAGES	ASSESSMENT
15	Unit 12 — Weathering & Soils	164–178	Quiz 14
16	Unit 13a — Earth's interior & continental drift	179–190	Quiz 15
17	Unit 13b — Earth's Tectonic Plates	191–198	Quiz 16
18	Unit 14 — Tectonic Force & Earthquakes	199–211	Quiz 17
19	Unit 15 — Volcanoes	212–225	Quiz 18 TEST 3 • UNITS 12–14
20	Unit 16 — Shaped by Coastal Processes	226–241	Quiz 19
21	Unit 17a — Rivers & Running Water	242–253	Quiz 20
22	Unit 17b — Water Storage & Groundwater	254–259	Quiz 21

WEEK	READ	PAGES	ASSESSMENT
23	Unit 18 — Shaped by Wind	260–273	Quiz 22 TEST 4 · UNITS 15–17
24	Unit 19a — Glaciers & Glacial Erosion	274–287	Quiz 23
25	Unit 19b — Glacial Lakes & Deposition	288–293	Quiz 24
26	REVIEW & FINAL EXAM	<i>review</i>	FINAL · Units 12–19

287 pages across 24 reading weeks — about 12 pages a week. Weeks 6, 17, 22, and 25 are the lightest; if the class falls behind, make up the time there.